

Mountain life

This sugarbush is an endangered plant in its native South Africa.

Serpentine sugarbush



Forget-me-not

Many heads of bright yellow flowers burst out of each rosette.

These tightly curled heads of pink buds open into blue flowers.

The alpine pink's tiny leaves are almost hidden by large flowers in spring.



Alpine pink

The tall flower spikes develop quickly in spring.

Broadleaf stonecrop

Star-shaped flowers attract pollinating bees.

Alpine spotted orchid

Fleshy blue-green leaves are spade-shaped.

Cobweb house-leek

Life up a mountain is harsh. At high altitude, plants are exposed to extreme temperatures, freezing weather in winter, and intense sunlight in summer. The thin soil is dry. Yet some hardy plants manage to survive here. Many have short stems to keep out of the wind and small leaves to reduce heat and water loss. They usually hug the ground in clumps. Some plants even have silver or white leaves to reflect sunlight.